

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 295

By Hemmer

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of James Stephen Turner
of Nashville.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of
the passing of James Stephen Turner; and

WHEREAS, Steve Turner was an esteemed business leader and consummate
professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in
numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Turner was born on February 26, 1947, in Scottsville, Kentucky, as the
youngest member of the founding family of Dollar General; throughout his life, he always
appreciated the small-town values of the community in which he was raised and admired the
way neighbors and friends looked after one another; and

WHEREAS, a romantic in many ways, Steve Turner found the love of his life, Judy
Turner, at an early age, asking her out on their first date before he even had his driver's license;
and

WHEREAS, Mr. Turner honorably served his nation as a member of the United States
Army and carried forward the lessons of selfless service into every aspect of his life; and

WHEREAS, his professional journey began at Dollar General and continued at Farmers
National Bank in Scottsville, but his most significant legacy is the transformative impact he had
on downtown Nashville; and

WHEREAS, upon moving to Nashville in 1986, Steve Turner envisioned and tirelessly
pursued a dream of revitalizing downtown Nashville; in time, he brought his unique creativity
and dedication to fruition, particularly in the development of The Gulch, a project so remarkable
that it served as the spark that emboldened the unprecedented development of the core of
Music City; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Turner's civic engagement and passion for the arts and community were evident in his leadership roles, including serving as chairman of the Country Music Hall of Fame and Museum and as a board member of the Frist Art Museum, the Tennessee Performing Arts Center, and the Nashville Symphony, where he chaired the Building Committee for the Schermerhorn Symphony Center, which houses the concert hall named for his mother, Laura Turner; and

WHEREAS, he also contributed significantly to Nashville's academic and business communities as a member of the Board of Trust of Vanderbilt University, the Nashville Area Chamber of Commerce, Cumberland Region Tomorrow, and the Transit Alliance of Middle Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, Steve Turner's philanthropic legacy is carried forward by the next generations of the Turner family through the James Stephen Turner Family Foundation; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Turner was deeply devoted to his family, and he always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, left to cherish his memory are his son, Jay (Christi) Turner; grandchildren, Katherine and Stephen; brother, Cal Turner, Jr.; and a multitude of nieces and nephews; and

WHEREAS, he was preceded in death by his beloved wife, Judy Turner; parents, Cal and Laura Katherine Turner; daughter, Laura Anne; and sisters, Laura Jo Dugas and Betty Turner Campbell; and

WHEREAS, Steve Turner leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of James Stephen Turner, reflecting fondly upon his

impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Turner.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.